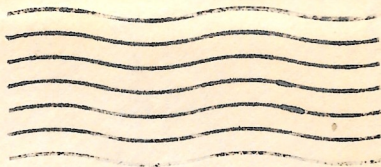


P.T. D.T. Hoffstetter Jr.
 37416383 P.T. Dir.
 12th Mobile R.R. Sq. A.P. 636
 Cb P.M. N.Y. N.Y.



Miss MARTHA DARROUGH
 DUTHERAN HOSPITAL
 School of Nursing
 St. Louis, Mo.

Check & send
 envelope

S

EXAMINER



AMERICAN RED CROSS

Nov. 4, 1944
England

Dearest Martha,

This is my day off
and I am in town. So that will
explain the paper. I have
not heard from you for a
while. In fact it has been
about 2 weeks. I hope that
nothing has happened to you.
But I guess the reason you
did not write is because
your studies are going hard
now! But on second thought you
may get a good-looking sailor by
now. Can you tell a friend all about
it.

I guess I should not talk to
much about not writing as
I have not written in more than
a week. But the bad men



AMERICAN RED CROSS

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the hospital with an infected thumb. And of all the phases it had to be in my right hand ~~therefore~~ ^{where} I could not hold the pen good. I guess the other days you can just put down as busy.

I have not read any thing in your last couple letters about your father in the South Pacific. I hope that he is O.K. And not like my brother.

As he had been in the hospital with scarlet fever I think he is out by now at least I hope so. He just got in the hospital maybe then went to the hospital. The nurse up there write mother a letter. So you are too good the nurse are. I wish we had him in the place I was but I had bad like luck. They had only men.



AMERICAN RED CROSS

3.

I can just see you laughing
at me. But I am not as lucky
as the boys or ~~men~~ at Pultham
Hospital. I wish you were
at the Hospital when I was there.

As far as news over here
it's very little. One of the boys
in over barrack, who is a good friend
of mine. Had a birthday the 2nd of
Nov. and we all went out & had
a good time. There is a boy I know
in Camp & a girl I know in town
but has their birthday the
same day as mine. So we are
all going out. I never took
this girl out as she is a ~~big~~ the
kind of a girl that can wait till
we are married. Maybe she has not
^{found} the man that can hold
her down. Well any way I guess
we will have a good
time. But I sure would



AMERICAN RED CROSS

x.

like to be home. As this is
my second birthday away
from home. The last one was
in Calif. If I get back by the
next one I will be happy. I
will have a year over here
very soon. If it does not seem
that long but I guess it is. If
I think of all the times we could
of gone out. Can you imagine all
the dates we missed, all the
blackouts, or all the party parties.
Well if I do not get home soon I
will have gray hair. I sure
do not look like I will make
it by your day of graduation. But
I still have my fingers crossed.

I sent you a Christmas present
a couple days ago. I hope that
you get it by Christmas. But if
you are lucky & get it before



AMERICAN RED CROSS

5

I guess I hope that you ^{will} wait
until Christmas. It's not much
but save this you can remember me
by. And that I was over here. I think
the last Christmas present you got
from me was a ring for Cliff. So
you got a lot of things from all
over. Well that's enough about it.

One of the boys in our barracks
got Christmas packages in one
day. So he got his share. The boys
have been getting cards or packages
since Oct 20. So we have
Christmas just about every day
since then. And I guess we
will have it after Christmas &
so you see we got our part of
Christmas as I hope you do.

This is a very nice day out
side. The sunlight is all over
this paper as I write to you.



AMERICAN RED CROSS

I hope that it is the same with
you. I mean a good day. I would
like to play some football after the
winter but I guess that ^{will} ~~will~~
not go. as I don't have ^{not} any
clothes.

I just had this joke called to my
attention. It is a plan waiting for mail
for months, finally got a card
with from the Armstrong Lincoln
Company informing him. "The Armstrong
office nearest you is located at
295 Fifth Avenue N.Y."

I think that is just about
all for now. I thought
I was going to be a visit with
but as you see I did not stay
in time. I hope you are in good
health & happy.

With lots of love &
many kisses, which I hope
I get. I love
you & am thinking of you!